participating in the suppression of my Palestinian people," he wrote in a letter to Netanyahu.[9]

Netanyahu tried to calm the furor in a November 2014 meeting with Druze leaders. "You are our very flesh. You are an organic part of Israeli society. Your heroic policemen and soldiers have fallen in order to defend the state and all its citizens, but we will defend your rights and your security," he said. Soon afterward, he announced a $500 million plan to improve infrastructure and create jobs in Druze communities. Again, though, the nation-state bill overshadowed his efforts. Bahij Mansour, the Israeli ambassador to the Dominican Republic and a member of the Druze community, denounced it in a sharp editorial for *Ha'aretz*, a highly unusual step for a civil servant. "This law sends a sharp and clear message to the Druze of Israel, 'You are not our allies,'" he wrote.

Seif's parents, grief-stricken and exhausted, tried to be diplomatic with the parade of journalists who tramped through their modest home. "We're not angry," said his father Nohad. "We all sacrifice for this state, and we all support this state." By contrast his brother Murad said the nation-state bill was an insult, one that would do real damage to the long-standing alliance between the Druze and the state. "There are already people in the community who don't want to enlist, and that is a source of anger," he said. "What am I supposed to tell them now?"

Regional integration

There had been an ironic parallel some months earlier in Egypt, a neighboring country that seems worlds apart from Israel. The Muslim Brotherhood had recently swept the first-ever democratic elections, with a plurality in the parliament and Mohamed Morsi in the presidential palace. After several false starts, Islamists and secular politicians appointed a 100-member committee to amend the constitution. They held a thoughtful, fascinating public debate, the kind which is unlikely to be repeated in Egyptian politics anytime soon. (Mohamed Beltagy, the Brotherhood politician who led the committee, is now serving a 20-year prison sentence.)

Nothing was more controversial than Article 2, which sought to define the identity of the Egyptian state: "Islam is the religion of the state, and the Arabic language is its official language, and the principles of Islamic shari'a are the primary source of legislation."